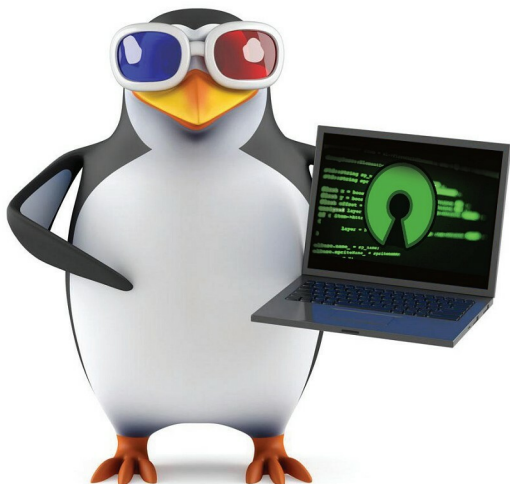


Ten Popular Open Source Tools for Developers

Here is a selection of the ten most popular open source tools for developers, along with a brief introduction to each.



As the new year has just started, let me present the top ten open source tools of the previous year for developers. This list includes version control systems, integrated development environments (IDEs), text editors, and Web and mobile frameworks. All these are regularly used by developers to create new applications.

1. Git

Git is a free and open source distributed version control system designed to handle everything from small to very large projects, with speed and efficiency. With the rise of GitHub, Git has become a *de facto* standard and, according to several surveys, is now the most popular version control system among software developers. Its users include all the biggest names in the technology industry, such as Google, Facebook, Twitter, Microsoft, LinkedIn and Netflix. It is also very popular with open source projects such as the Linux kernel, Eclipse, GNOME and others. Git is easy to learn and has a

tiny footprint, with lightning fast performance. It outclasses SCM tools like Subversion, CVS, Perforce and ClearCase with features like cheap local branching, convenient staging areas and multiple workflows.

2. Eclipse

Eclipse is an integrated development environment (IDE) used in computer programming. It is the most widely used Java IDE, but it also supports C/C++, PHP and JavaScript. Eclipse got started in 2001 when IBM donated three million lines of code from its Java tools to develop an open source integrated development environment. Eclipse is released under the terms of the Eclipse Public License. The Eclipse Foundation, which oversees development of the IDE, supports more than 250 open source projects, most of them related to development tools. There are also loads of plugins available that bring code quality, version control and other capabilities to the integrated development environment.